Receipts

The Claudettes · Track B, "The Passage"
Chart the Common Wealth · The Open Accelerator × Red Hat · 31 Oct 2026
Bret Kerr, with Claude

A founder says what they need. The Mass AI Atlas answers with a receipt: who's on the list, the month a person last checked each one, and what to doubt. Doubt is shown, never hidden.

THE PROBLEM, IN THIS MORNING'S NUMBERS

- **87 of 197** pins are a neighbourhood, not an address, and looked exactly like real ones (Probe 1).
- Only **13 of 61** funders state a check size (Probe 4), yet a founder sees a list with no caveat.
- **52** entries were last checked in June (Probe 5); only **5** sit west of Worcester (Probe 6).

WHAT WE BUILT (ONE HTML FILE, NO BUILD STEP)

1. **Ask in a sentence.** "I need ___", typed or spoken. Plain keyword rules set the Atlas's own *I need…* filters, which stay visible and editable. It never names an organization.
2. **Get a receipt.** The five surest matches, what each offers, the month a person checked it, and a ⚠ "trust less" line only where the data gives a reason.
3. **Compare the top two.** One click, one sentence: "Trust X less: …". This is the hand-off test.
4. **Probe 1 made visible.** Approximate pins are dashed rings; exact ones stay solid. Map tiles flip to their receipt.
5. **Review proposals.** Drop a file of proposed entries; six checks flag duplicates, wrong places, out-of-state, closed, unsourced facts and suspicious domains, each with a reason.

PROBE MADE VISIBLE: BEFORE → AFTER

PROBE	BEFORE	AFTER
1 · approximate pins	identical to addresses	dashed ring + legend "87 of 197"
4 · check sizes	silent	"Not sorted by check size: only 13 of 61 state one"
5 · freshness	flag only after 12 months	every line shows its month; ⚠ after 3
3 · startups, no stage	looked like a gap	"peers, not resources": not a doubt

A REAL RECEIPT

```
MASS AI ATLAS
"I need pre-seed money and a mentor"
-----------------------------------
MassVentures                 ✓ OCT 26
  offers funding · mentorship
Analog Devices               ✓ OCT 26
  ⚠ trust less: no check size stated
C10 Labs                     ✓ AUG 26
  ⚠ trust less: pin is a neighbourhood
-----------------------------------
OLDEST CHECK                   AUG 26
Not sorted by check size: only 13 of 61
funders state one.
```

Compare the top two → "Trust Analog Devices less: offers funding but states no check size."

WHAT IT REFUSES TO DO

✕ Hide or delete an entry for doubt. Flag, never delete.

✕ Sort funders by a check size most don't state.

✕ Name an organization from the founder's words.

✕ Call a proposal clean when its site wasn't checked: "Nothing flagged · site not checked."

WHY IT CAN MERGE ON MONDAY

Built inside the Atlas's own **`index.html`**: no build step, framework, database or key. Every number is computed in the browser from the YAML the Atlas already loads. All 32 of the repo's browser and accessibility tests pass; the data loader is vendored so it works on bad wifi.

Video youtu.be/VRSNQxPLBDM · **Repo** github.com/bretkerr/mass-ai-atlas/tree/receipts

Data: Mass AI Atlas, The Open Accelerator (CC BY 4.0) · Map: OpenStreetMap via OpenFreeMap · Code MIT